

Ishan Azad

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Email: iazad@smu.edu
Citizenship: Indian
Languages: Hindi (native), English (fluent)

Education

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati: B.Tech in Maths and Computing, 2016-20

Indian Statistical Institute Delhi: M.S. in Quantitative Economics, 2021-23

Southern Methodist University: M.A. in Economics, 2023-24

Southern Methodist University: Ph.D. in Economics (*ongoing*), 2023-

Research Interests

Information Economics, Game Theory

Working Paper

Trade Transparency and Buyer Learning ([Link](#))

This paper studies the welfare effects of trade transparency in a dynamic adverse-selection market where buyers can acquire costly, noisy private signals about seller quality. Under transparency, buyers observe whether the seller traded previously, but not prices. Transparency creates a learning effect, allowing later buyers to economize on private information acquisition while potentially discouraging efficient private learning, and a strategic distortion effect, as sellers alter current trade to influence future beliefs. The distortion depends on whether trade with the low-quality seller is efficient: transparency can induce overtrading when such trade is inefficient and undertrading when it is efficient. Welfare rises when public learning and acquisition-cost savings dominate these distortions, and falls when reduced information acquisition and distorted trade create sufficiently large allocative losses.

Awards and Fellowships

Cook Family Fellowship

2025-26, 2026-27

Inducted into the Omicron Delta Epsilon International Honor Society in Economics (SMU chapter)

2024

Teaching Experience

Strategic Behavior (UG)	Instructor	Fall 2026
Price Theory (UG)	Instructor	Summer I 2026
Microeconomic Theory I (PhD)	TA for Prof. Santanu Roy	2024, 2025
Microeconomic Theory II (PhD)	TA for Prof. Bo Chen	2025, 2026
Economic Analysis I (Masters)	TA for Prof. Bo Chen	2024, 2025
Principles of Microeconomics (UG)	TA for Prof. Santanu Roy	2024

Conference Presentations

37th Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory (Stony Brook University, 2026)

Extracurricular Activities

Member of the Organizing Team for Texas Economic Theory Camp	2025
Student Representative at Indian Statistical Institute Delhi	2022-23
Overall Placement Coordinator at Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati	2019-20

Corporate Experience

Summer Analyst, Citicorp Services India Limited	May '19 - Jul '19
Member Technical Staff, Oracle India Private Limited	Sept '20 - Oct '21

References

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